MILESTONE 6 DOCUMENTATION

ACS User Guide

How to run the current browser application, play the sample adventure, save local progress, use the editor, and launch playtests from a locally saved draft.

Overview

This project currently provides two browser pages:

- `apps/web/index.html`: the playable game runtime
- `apps/web/editor.html`: the construction-set editor

Both pages run locally over HTTP and store their data in the browser's IndexedDB database named `acs-local`.

- Game progress is saved in the browser.
- Editor drafts are saved in the browser.
- Playtesting a draft opens that draft in the same runtime used by the sample game.

Starting The Application

1. Build the TypeScript workspace if needed.
2. Start the local web server from the repo root.

```
node .\apps\web\server.mjs
```

3. Open the runtime in a browser: `http://localhost:4173/`
4. Open the editor in a browser: `http://localhost:4173/apps/web/editor.html`

If port `4173` is already in use in your environment, use the alternate port configured for your session, such as `4317`.

Playing The Game

The playable runtime loads the built-in sample adventure by default. That adventure is currently `Oracle of the Solar Seal`.

The runtime page with the map canvas, sidebar, event log, and status summary.

Objective

- Speak to the Oracle.
- Enter the shrine.
- Claim the Solar Seal.
- Return to the Oracle.

Controls

- `W`, `A`, `S`, `D` or arrow keys: move
- `E`: interact with an adjacent entity
- `Q`: inspect the current tile or an adjacent entity
- `Enter` or `Space`: advance dialogue

What You See On Screen

- A canvas playfield showing the current map
- A map name display and player coordinates
- Turn count, flags, and inventory summary
- An event log
- A dialogue overlay when a trigger starts dialogue

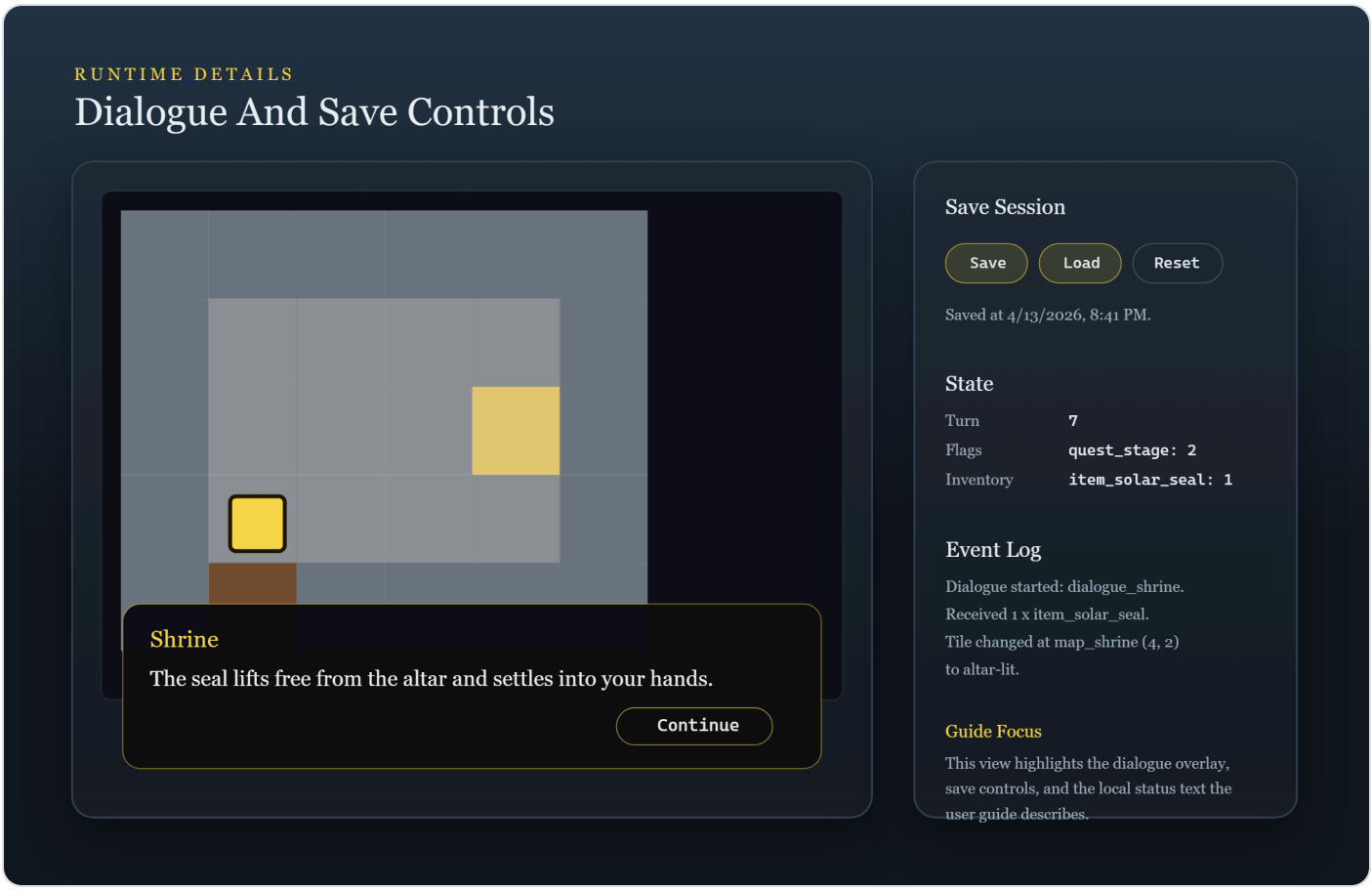
Basic Play Flow

- The player moves one tile at a time.
- Exits can transfer you from one map to another.
- Triggers may fire when you enter certain tiles or interact with entities.

- Enemy AI may respond during the enemy phase.
- The event log records movement, trigger execution, dialogue, item rewards, and enemy behavior.

Saving And Loading Game Progress

The runtime page has three buttons: `Save`, `Load`, and `Reset`.



The runtime's save controls, dialogue overlay, state panel, and event log.

Save

`Save` stores the current runtime snapshot locally in IndexedDB.

- Built-in sample adventure slot: `adv_milestone3:latest`
- Draft playtest slot: `<adventure id>:draft-playtest`

Load

`Load` restores the most recent locally saved snapshot for the active save slot. If no save exists for that slot, the runtime reports that no local save is available.

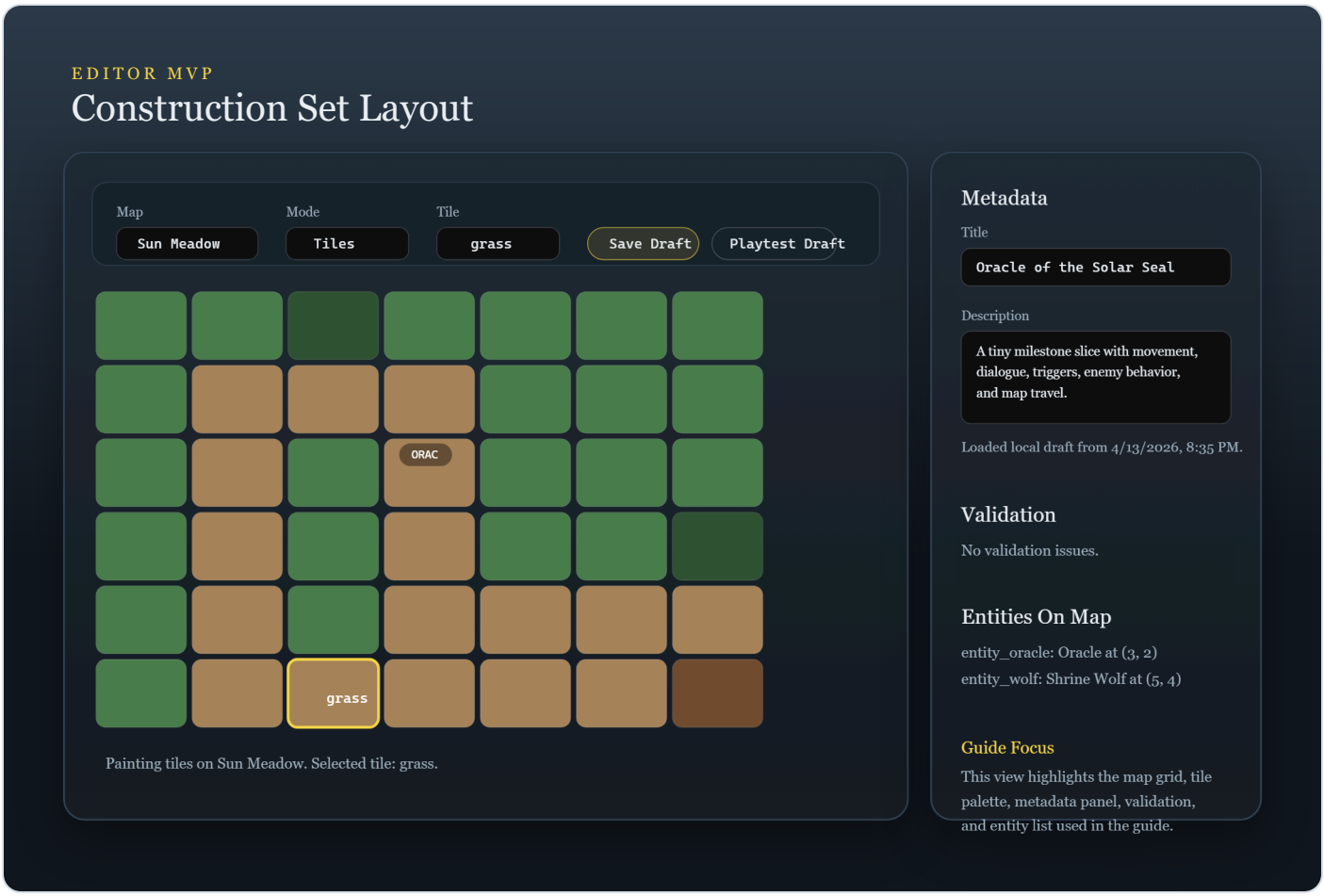
Reset

`Reset` restarts the current adventure from its start state. It does not delete your saved snapshot; it only resets the active session in memory.

Persistence note: all persistence so far is browser-local. Saves are not shared across browsers, are not synced to a server, and may be lost if browser storage is cleared.

Using The Editor

The editor is available at `apps/web/editor.html`.



The construction-set editor with the map grid, toolbar, metadata panel, validation list, and entity summary.

It is currently an MVP construction-set page focused on editing adventure metadata, painting map tiles, moving existing entities, validating the draft, saving the draft locally, and launching a playtest from the draft.

Main Areas Of The Editor

- The editing panel on the left contains the map grid and toolbar.
- The sidebar on the right contains metadata, validation messages, and entity summaries.

Top Buttons

- `Back To Play`: opens the normal playable runtime page

- `Save Draft`: stores the current draft locally in IndexedDB
- `Reset Draft`: restores the built-in sample adventure and deletes the saved local draft
- `Playtest Draft`: saves the current draft locally and opens a new tab running that draft in the game runtime

Editing Metadata

The `Metadata` panel includes `Title` and `Description`. Typing in either field immediately updates the in-memory draft. The draft is not permanently stored until you click `Save Draft` or `Playtest Draft`.

Working With Maps

The toolbar above the grid includes `Map`, `Mode`, `Tile`, and `Entity`.

- The `Map` dropdown switches between maps in the current adventure package.
- The current sample includes `Sun Meadow` and `Inner Shrine`.
- Changing the selected map redraws the editor grid and updates the entity summary for that map.

Tile Editing

1. Set `Mode` to `Tiles`.
2. Choose a tile from the `Tile` dropdown.
3. Click a cell in the grid.

The clicked cell is rewritten to the selected tile id. The tile palette is built from tile ids already present on the current map plus a fallback palette of known tiles such as `grass`, `path`, `shrub`, `stone`, `floor`, `altar`, `altar-lit`, `door`, and `water`.

Entity Editing

1. Set `Mode` to `Entities`.
2. Choose an entity from the `Entity` dropdown.
3. Click a destination cell in the grid.

The selected entity instance is moved to the currently selected map and clicked coordinates. Milestone 6 supports repositioning only; it does not yet create or delete entities.

Validation

The `Validation` panel runs shared package validation against the current draft. If the draft is valid, it shows `No validation issues.`. Otherwise, each issue is listed with severity and message.

Saving And Resetting Drafts

- `Save Draft` stores the current draft in IndexedDB using a key derived from the adventure id, currently `draft:adv_milestone3`.
- When the editor opens, it first checks for that saved draft.
- `Reset Draft` restores a fresh clone of the built-in sample adventure and deletes the saved draft record.

Playtesting A Draft

1. The editor saves the current draft locally.
2. The editor opens a new browser tab.
3. That tab loads the normal game runtime with a `draft` query parameter.
4. The runtime looks up the saved draft in IndexedDB.
5. If found, the runtime plays the draft instead of the built-in sample adventure.

This means the playtest page is not a separate engine. It is the same runtime page, pointed at your saved draft content.

Current Limitations

- No server-backed user accounts
- No cloud save sync
- No publishing flow yet
- No creation or deletion of maps from the editor
- No creation or deletion of entity definitions or entity instances
- No trigger editor yet
- No dialogue editor yet
- No asset pipeline yet
- The runtime renderer is still a simple canvas renderer using colored tiles and abstract entity markers

Troubleshooting

The runtime says no local save exists

This usually means you have not saved yet for the current adventure or draft playtest slot, or you are in a different browser/profile than the one that created the save.

The editor does not show my previous draft

Possible causes include cleared browser storage, a different browser/profile, or a prior draft reset.

Playtest opens but shows the sample adventure

This happens when the runtime cannot find the draft key passed by the editor. In that case, the runtime falls back to the built-in sample adventure and reports that in the status text.

Milestone 6 Summary

- A playable browser runtime for a sample ACS-inspired adventure
- A local draft editor for that adventure

- A local persistence layer for both gameplay progress and editor drafts
- A playtest loop that lets the editor launch the runtime against the saved draft